CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

VOICE ACTOR IN THE AI ERA

Your studio is a closet full of blankets, your commute is zero, and your voice can work in three time zones before lunch.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K median for established voices; the craft and home setup come together in 1–6 months, no license required. The catch: auditions are the job — hundreds of no's feed a handful of yes's.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

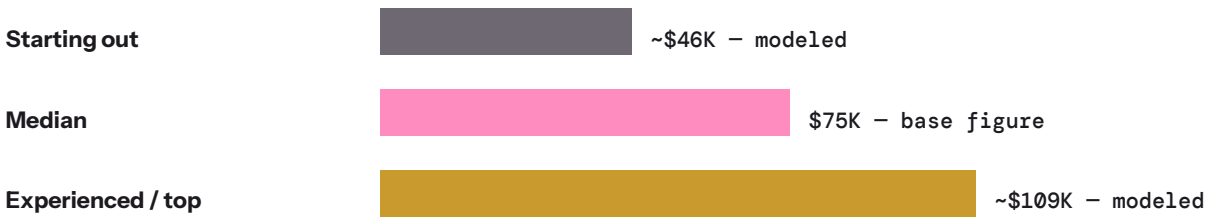
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: ads, explainers, audiobooks, games and e-learning all run on voices, and recording went fully home-based.
- Where it bites: it is an audition business — rejection volume shocks every beginner.
- The AI angle: synthetic voices took the cheapest read-it-plain work; clients still cast humans for character, trust and brand identity.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Voice Actor is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A VOICE ACTOR ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Audition constantly: short scripts, fast turnaround, thick skin
- ✓ Record commercial, narration and character work from a treated home space
- ✓ Take direction live on calls and re-cut until the read lands
- ✓ Run the business: demos, invoices, agents and repeat clients

Think: an actor whose entire instrument fits in a throat — and whose stage is a padded closet.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Text-to-speech voices now handle generic narration, IVR menus and low-budget explainers at scale. Casting platforms automate submissions and contracts.	Performance stays human at the money end: comedic timing, warmth a brand can own, characters with a point of view, and live direction in a session. Buyers cast a voice they can build on.

⚠ **A pretty voice is not the skill — acting is. Untrained voices book a few auditions, wonder why, and quit before the craft arrives.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Fully remote, pajama-compatible work ✓ Every script is a different character or world ✓ Sessions pay well per hour once you are castable	✗ Audition grind: most of the job is unpaid trying ✗ Your voice is the asset — colds are sick days ✗ Isolation: a booth, a screen, your own direction

Good fit? You act for fun anyway, take direction without sulking, and can hear feedback as fuel. Bad fit? You only 'have a nice voice' and no interest in acting craft or rejection math.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — TRAIN, DEMO, CASTING SITES	DOOR B — DIRECT-TO-BUSINESS NARRATION
Take actual voice acting coaching, record a professional demo in one genre, and work the casting platforms daily. This is the standard pipeline — coaches and demos exist because casting directors can hear amateur in four seconds.	Sell explainer, training and phone-system voice work directly to businesses and e-learning producers. Less glamorous than animation, steadier than it — and it pays for your booth while you chase the fun roles.

Smart move: Pick a lane your voice actually fits — commercial, narration, character — and demo only that. Casting buys specialists; 'versatile' usually means unbookable.
Where you land after: A rostered voice with agent representation, repeat brand work and a demo in a second genre.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
TRAIN THE	BUILD THE	RECORD A	AUDITION EVERY	FIRST PAYING	AGENT AND

STEP 1 — Train the acting, not the voice

$100-400 · MONTH 1

- Voice acting classes or coaching — in person or live online
- Learn mic technique and script marking

STEP 2 — Build the booth

$300-800 · MONTHS 1-2

- A treated quiet space: closet, blankets, whatever kills echo
- A decent condenser mic and interface — quiet beats expensive

STEP 3 — Record a real demo

MONTH 2

- Sixty seconds, one genre, professionally produced if possible
- Your demo is your entire first impression — no DIY shortcuts

STEP 4 — Audition every day

MONTHS 2-4

- Casting platforms and direct outreach, daily reps
- Track auditions to bookings — it is a numbers funnel

STEP 5 — First paying clients

MONTHS 3-5

- Explainers, local ads, e-learning — the working voice's bread
- Deliver fast and clean; producers rebook reliability

STEP 6 — Agent and second genre

MONTHS 5-6

- Submit to agents with bookings already behind you
- Add a second demo only when the first is earning

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: record yourself reading three ad scripts on your phone and listen honestly.

- Days 1–30: start coaching; build the quiet booth corner; practice daily.
- Days 31–60: produce your demo; join casting platforms; begin daily auditions.
- Days 61–90: push auditions, land first small paid work, deliver fast.
- Day 90: a working voice actor in the funnel — bookings scale with auditions and craft.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **ACTING FIRST. VOICE SECOND.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.